

He believed that the world was like a fabric woven from many threads of knowledge, and he wanted to understand them all.



Leonardo was unique in the way he used scientific and mathematical principles to guide his work. For example, he divided the face into seven parts to help him draw it more accurately. As he wrote later, “The space between the parting of the lips and the base of the nose is one-seventh of the face.”

One of Verrocchio’s paintings from around 1475, *The Baptism of Christ*, has an angel on the far left that many experts believe, after studying the brushstrokes, is actually the work of Leonardo. It is the most realistic of the figures in the painting. Clearly, Leonardo was becoming ready to be a master himself.